

Summary Cardiovascular disease (CVD) prevention in ESC guidance focuses on modifiable risk-factor control, regular physical activity, and public-health policies.

Key recommendations

Area	Recommendation
Tobacco	No exposure to tobacco in any form.
Diet	Low-saturated-fat diet rich in whole-grain products, vegetables, fruit and fish.
Physical activity	≥150 min/week moderate aerobic activity (or 75 min/week vigorous, or a mix). Physical activity can cut relative cardiovascular mortality by ~27 % and is safe for most patients when appropriately assessed.
Body weight	Body-mass-index 20–25 kg/m ² ; waist < 94 cm (men) or < 80 cm (women).
Blood pressure	Target < 140/90 mmHg (lower in diabetes, higher may be acceptable in frail elderly).
Patient counselling	Individualised advice, taking preferences and obstacles into account; consistent follow-up improves adherence.
Policy & societal actions	Smoking bans, air-quality improvements, stress-management initiatives and addressing socioeconomic disparities are recognised as powerful upstream measures. Emerging risk factors such as air pollution, inflammation, stress and COVID-19 are now incorporated into prevention strategies.
Future priorities	Reduce non-ischemic CVD, close socioeconomic gaps, enhance lifestyle adherence, and develop novel therapies.

Sources

- *Risk Factors and Cardiovascular Disease Prevention* (OE4_ff5e6444-8ce4-4672-a308-5349aa400552)- *Physical activity for cardiovascular prevention* (OE4_9f2c6fd7-985b-427e-8654-47d6215a058e)
- *Specific clinical targets for cardiovascular disease prevention* (OE4_89175f51-f349-4b69-9d6f-8f23a1163dd0)
- 2023 ESC Congress presentation on CVD burden and prevention (P269904)